

92% excellent bathing water

A public claim, tested against eleven seasons of EEA data

THE CLAIM

“92% of Maltese bathing waters are of excellent quality.”

European Commission, EIR 2025: Malta

The 92% matches 80 of 87 sites in 2023, the season the Commission's full report names.

The 2024 season gave the same count. The summary sentence does not state the year.

VERDICT

SUPPORTED

*Right for 2023–24;
date the figure.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

80 / 87

Excellent in 2023 and 2024

92.0% both seasons, matching the Commission's statement when it was published.

77 / 87

Excellent in 2025

88.5%: the lowest of the eleven seasons since 2015 (98.9% in 2016–2018).

88.3%

EU-27 coastal average, 2025

Malta's lead over it shrank from 11 points in 2016 to 0.2 in 2025.

4 seasons

Balluta Bay B08 and B09

Rated only sufficient every season 2022–2025; a 2024 warning fell within that run.

10 of 87

Sites ever below excellent

In 2025 St George's Bay B03 and Xlendi D06/D07 fell to good; two other sites improved.

FAIR TO SAY

The 92% was accurate and current when published. Since then the share has fallen to 88.5%; classification uses two microbiological indicators and four seasons of samples.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ State the season year beside the 92% figure.

☐ Use the latest EEA result (2025: 88.5%) for current conditions.

☐ Explain why Balluta Bay has stayed at the minimum class.

☐ Report the decline since 2018 alongside the headline share.